

**Case: a side air bag fault** (U.S. vehicle-defect investigation, 27 evidence items). The file holds 5,235 warranty claims for module/connector replacements (E2.2), a campaign “to repair the defective air bag electrical connectors” (E3.1), and crash tests with the side air bags disabled (E3.6).

**Official finding:** faulty connectors can deactivate the side air bag – the case should be closed.

**Test** (brief unchanged apart from its item index): *control* removes two unrelated items (E3.8, E3.12); *grounds removed* drops the two items the reference answer relies on (E3.1, E3.6), restated nowhere else.

✓ **Control: closes**

Nautil-SFT (9B) · control (E3.8, E3.12 removed)

**CASE CLOSED.** The best-supported cause of the reported failures is defective side-thorax air-bag electrical connectors ... (E1.1, E2.2, E3.1). *The manufacturer conducted a service campaign to repair those connectors ...*

The 5,235 warranty claims for module or connector replacements ... support a component-related failure pattern, but do not prove why each individual part failed (E2.2, E3.5).

✓ **Grounds removed: stays open**

Nautil-SFT (9B) · E3.1, E3.6 removed

**CASE NOT CLOSED** – the cause of the reported side thorax air bag module and connector failures is unresolved.

*The record supports a possible component problem: 5,235 warranty claims were for those replacements on 3,927 of 13,836 subject vehicles (E2.2, E3.5). It does not establish why individual components failed.*

✗ **Grounds removed: closes anyway**

Qwen3.5-9B (base) · E3.1, E3.6 removed

*The evidence does not explicitly state why the connectors failed ... but it confirms the mechanism ...*

**CASE CLOSED**

Supported Mechanism: The cause was a reliability failure of the side thorax air bag module/connector assemblies, leading to non-deployment or malfunction ...